

Fridge Organization Map

A place for everything, where each food stays freshest.

DATE SORTED

HOME

Fridges aren't the same temperature all over. Store each food in its ideal zone to cut waste and keep things fresh.

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Inside the Fridge, Top to Bottom

warmest → coldest

Top Shelf

Leftovers, drinks & ready-to-eat

Most stable temp. Cooked food, leftovers, herbs, packaged snacks and drinks. Nothing that needs the deepest cold.

Middle Shelf

Dairy & eggs

Milk, yogurt, cheese, butter for daily use and eggs (in their carton), steady cold keeps dairy at its best.

Lower Shelf

Meal prep & grab-and-go

Batch-cooked meals, portioned lunches and marinating dishes at eye level so they get eaten first.

Bottom Shelf

Raw meat, poultry & fish

The coldest zone. Keep on the lowest shelf on a tray so drips can't reach food below. Sealed until you cook.

Crisper Drawers

Produce, split by humidity

High humidity (vent closed): leafy greens, herbs, broccoli. **Low humidity** (vent open): apples, pears, ripening fruit.

The Door

warmest spot

Why It Matters

Set it to 37 °F (3 °C). Cold enough to slow spoilage, not so cold food freezes.

Leave room to breathe. Air needs to circulate, a packed fridge cools unevenly.

Bin it up. Clear bins group like items and pull out for easy cleaning.

Front row = eat first. Put the oldest items up front so nothing hides and spoils.

5-Minute Weekly Cleanout

before grocery day

- ☐ Toss anything past its use-by date
- ☐ Move soon-to-expire food to the front
- ☐ Wipe spills & sticky shelf spots
- ☐ Rinse produce drawers, dry well
- ☐ Consolidate half-empty jars & bottles
- ☐ Jot leftovers to eat this week

Set Up a Meal-Prep Zone

grab-and-go

Keep one clear bin for portioned lunches and snacks you can grab without thinking.

Store cut fruit & veggies in view at eye level, visible produce actually gets eaten.

Label meal-prep containers with the date made so nothing lingers too long.

Reserve a shelf edge for a "use me first" tray of leftovers and open items.

An organized fridge isn't about perfection, it's about seeing what you have, so good food gets eaten instead of forgotten.

FRIDGE TEMP

37 °F

FREEZER TEMP

0 °F

LEFTOVERS KEEP

3-4 days

CLEANOUT DAY

Fridge Bin Labels

Cut out, tape to your bins, and everything finds its home.

PRINTED ON

BINS USED

Print on cardstock, cut along the dashed lines, and tape or clip one to each bin. Great for the fridge, freezer or pantry.

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✂ cut along the dashed lines

Dairy
milk • cheese • yogurt

Eggs
keep cold, not in door

Produce
high-humidity drawer

Fruit
low-humidity drawer

Leftovers
eat within 3-4 days

Meal Prep
ready to grab

Snacks
grab & go

Drinks
chilled & ready

Condiments
sauces & spreads

Deli & Cheese
sliced & sealed

Meat & Fish
bottom shelf only

Breakfast
quick mornings

Lunches
packed & ready

Butter & Spreads
door friendly

Herbs & Greens
wash before use

Leftovers & Meal-Prep Tracker

eat me first

ITEM	MADE ON	USE BY	✓
			P
			P
			P
			P
			P
			P

Tip: keep this tracker on the fridge door with a magnet, a quick glance tells the whole family what to finish before it's gone.